

INDIVIDUAL PORTFOLIO EXAM

The assignment is to be addressed individually. The purpose of the exams is to test the learning outcomes of the course.

Module leader(s) and e-mail:

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The individual portfolio exam consists of four parts, which must all be addressed. When you address a part of the exam, please do clearly mark which part you are responding to (Example: A response to part 1, should be marked with 1.)

Exam: Developing a research proposal

Developing a research proposal is an integral part of the academic research process and consists of several tasks. The aim of this assignment is to draw upon what you have learned so far and identify a topic you would like to focus your investigation on. You will need to think through how you can develop a strategy and apply your methods in order to carry out your investigation systematically.

You are free to choose any research area that you find interesting from your field of study or related fields as long as it contains an IT aspect. This is also an opportunity for defining, planning and working in a research area relevant for your Bachelor thesis.

A research proposal might include the following elements:

- The research topic – your chosen area of research.
- The research problem that you are trying to address and the importance of that problem?
- The research objective – what do you want to find out and what is your goal with this particular research proposal?
- The potential research question(s) of your planned study.
- An outline of the background for the investigation based on related and prevailing knowledge relevant for your study.
- A description of the research strategy and method(s) you propose to use to address your research problem and question. Please, do state your argument for the choices you make and how they are appropriate in terms of your research objective and question.
- A discussion of the proposed plan and preparation of the data collection (i.e. what type of data should be collected, how much, size and type of sample, time estimations for data collection, etc.).
- A discussion of how you propose to analyse and interpret the data.
- A discussion of the potential limitations of your planned study, and how they could potentially impact the quality of your results.
- A discussion of the ethical implications of your study and data collection.
- A discussion of your expected contributions to research and practice.

This is not an exhaustive list. You may include other relevant information that you believe is important to explain your research proposal and the choices you make. It

is important that you can justify all of your choices and answer the 'why' question in relation to the points listed above.

Part I: Developing the research problem, aim and objective

Give a brief description of the project's background. You must document familiarity with the prevailing knowledge in your research field as well as the key challenges residing in the field. Describe your project's originality as well as how it might contribute to a practical (and – if applicable – academic) problem. For example: will the project help to solve needs and challenges for a business? State your research aim and objective – and if applicable, your research question.

Part I: Censor guidance:

- Bachelor students are not required to do research, but they are expected to know their methodology and methods and be able to apply them
- It is therefore not expected that they develop an original research idea. Instead we should evaluate if it is a relevant, useful, well understood and well applied idea. Context matters in this part of the evaluation
- A good response to this part will have a good disposition and a clear outline and argumentation for the premise of the idea, the central problem and/or challenge that it will investigate, an idea of how the proposal might help to solve the problem and/or challenge.
- A good response will refine the research problem into a (one) research question that is well connected with the problem. If more research questions are listed there should be a clear hierarchy (main and sub-questions)
- A good response will outline possible contributions from the proposal in (a) practice and, if applicable, (b) academia.
- A good proposal will also outline the importance of the project as well as its interestingness.

Part II: Discovering and applying existing knowledge

Develop a plan for how you would like to investigate the related and prevailing knowledge relevant for your study. Develop an initial structure for searching the literature based on keywords and boolean operators. Suggest relevant data bases for conducting your searches. Report initial results including criteria of relevance for including or excluding existing knowledge in your project. Present your initial results in a relevant table and outline your initial analysis.

Part II: Censor guidance:

- Important to look at the process of developing the literature review spanning from developing key words, defining search strings, choosing data bases and testing search strings
- Ideally, they will land on one search string, which they report results for
- Ideally, they will indicate some idea about how they sorted through the results and decided to include some and exclude others (criteria of in-/exclusion)
- Ideally, they will be able to communicate what they have learned from the articles that they included and how they helped to inform their own research strategy (that will be reported in Part 3)
- Writing part 2 can be supported by the use of tables, which can be woven into the manuscript and help to visualize the process. Relevant tables incl.:
 - Search words
 - Search strings
 - Search logs
 - [PRISMA](#) figure

Part III: Constructing your research strategy

Present your research strategy and methods for achieving your aim and objective. Justify your choice of approach and explain how it is suitable for investigating the research objective. Explain how you intend to collect the data you need and how you intend to analyse it in order to advance your project.

Part III: Censor guidance:

- In this part they have to develop a suitable strategy for studying the research problem, which ideally will be informed by the literature.
- In the course, they have been introduced to six different research strategies (experiment, survey, action research, case study, ethnography and design science). Ideally, they will choose one(!) of those for their study
- In the course, we distinguish between research strategy and research design. The research design is understood as a way of developing your research strategy. For example: You can choose a sequential design, where you first collect questionnaire data and then follow up with interviews to understand in depth. Ideally, they will show an understanding of this in their proposal
- In the course, they have been introduced to four different ways of collecting data (questionnaires, interviews, observations, document review). Ideally, they will suggest to use one or more of these in their proposal
- Ideally, they will suggest concrete methods for analyzing the data that they propose to collect

Part IV: Critically evaluating your approach

Discuss and evaluate how your approach will help you to complete your project. Offer informed reflections on data analysis and interpretations, possible opportunities and limitations as well as the ethics of the study. Finally, do discuss the intended contributions to practice (and – if applicable – academia), and demonstrate why your research project should be interesting to others.

Part IV: Censor guidance:

- This part is deliberately written in an open form, which is adaptable to the variation of study context. Therefore students also need to perform a critical assessment of what is important for them to discuss in this section
- A good response would offer informed reflections on elements such as validity, reliability, limitations, delimitations and similar
- A good response would offer informed reflections on ethical perspectives of the proposal. This might include whether or not they will be collecting person identifiable information and should submit the proposal for SIKT approval and similar
- A good response would include informed reflections on the contributions of the proposal to practice, academia and society. It could also include reflections on the interestingness of the study and how it can help to achieve impact.

The written home exams should be written at a level that reflects the lectures, reading materials and an expanded literature search. The research proposal should therefore also be reflective of the possibility that you could be able to take part in it yourself if it was to become reality.

Formatting:

The exams report should be in accordance with Kristiania University College's policies.

The exams report should include relevant references to literature incl. the course curriculum.

Language:

The exams report may be written in either Norwegian, Swedish, Danish or English.

Word limit:

The exams report should not exceed 4.000 words (excluding front page and references).

Section Weights:

Part I: 25

Part II: 25

Part III: 25

Part IV: 25

Total: 100

Informal Grading Criteria

Marks (Grade)

=>90 (A)

80-89(B)

70-79 (C)

60-69 (D)

50-59 (E)

<49 (F)

Grading

The assignment is worth 100 % of the grade of the course.

Assessment Criteria* Grade	Learning Outcome 1: Knowledge	Learning Outcome 2: Skills	Learning Outcome 3: Competence
A Excellent	Excellent and comprehensive understanding of theory	Demonstrates excellent analytical, technical and writing skills	Outstanding degree of judgment and independent critical thinking
B Very good	Very good understanding of theory	Demonstrates very good analytical, technical and writing skills	Sound degree of judgment and independent critical thinking
C Good	Good understanding of theory in most important areas	Demonstrates good analytical, technical and writing skills	Reasonable degree of judgment and independent critical thinking
D Satisfactory	Satisfactory understanding of theory, but with significant shortcomings	Demonstrates limited analytical, technical and writing skills	Limited degree of judgment and independent critical thinking
E Sufficient	Meets the minimum understanding of theory	Demonstrates sufficient analytical, technical and writing skills	Very limited degree of judgment and independent critical thinking

F Fail	Fail to meet the minimum academic criteria.	No demonstration of analytical, technical and writing skills	Absence of judgment and independent critical thinking
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*Adapted from The Norwegian Association of Higher Education Institutions
(http://www.uhr.no/utdanning/karakterpanel_1)